

NSW Energy Rebates — Website Copy (for Dev)

Last updated: June 2026 **Instructions for dev:** Each product below has a heading, body copy, and a short "key facts" list. Copy the text as-is or restyle to match the site. Do NOT change the dollar figures or eligibility wording — they have been fact-checked against official NSW Government (energy.nsw.gov.au), IPART, the Clean Energy Regulator, and the Clean Energy Council sources. The disclaimer at the bottom should appear on the page (footer or end of section).

Solar Panels

Heading: Solar Panel Rebates in NSW

Homeowners in NSW can reduce the upfront cost of a new solar system through the federal Small-scale Renewable Energy Scheme (SRES). The scheme creates Small-scale Technology Certificates (STCs) based on the amount of electricity your system is expected to generate, and the value is applied as an upfront discount on your installation quote. A typical 6.6kW system in the Sydney region attracts around \$1,840 in STC value, though the exact amount depends on system size, your location and the current STC market price.

There is no separate NSW state rebate for solar panels — solar incentives are delivered federally. NSW state support is instead focused on batteries and grid participation (see below).

Key facts:

- Delivered as an upfront discount via STCs (federal SRES)
 - Panels and inverter must be on the Clean Energy Council (CEC) approved product list
 - Must be installed by a CEC-accredited installer
 - System generally must be under 100kW
 - STC value steps down each year and the scheme ends in 2030 — installing earlier means a larger discount
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Battery Storage

Heading: Solar Battery Rebates & VPP Incentive in NSW

NSW households can now access two separate incentives that stack together to bring down the cost of a home battery.

1. Federal Cheaper Home Batteries Program — an upfront discount on the battery itself. From May to December 2026 the value is \$272 per usable kWh of capacity (down from \$336 earlier in 2026). The battery must be 5–50 kWh and installed with solar (new or existing) by an accredited installer using approved products. The discount is tiered — the first 14 kWh receives the full rate, the next portion up to 28 kWh receives a reduced rate, and capacity beyond that receives a much smaller rate.

2. NSW VPP Incentive (Peak Demand Reduction Scheme) — an additional state payment of up to \$1,500 (depending on battery size) for connecting your battery to an approved Virtual Power Plant (VPP). Most households receive around \$1,100. This is separate from the federal discount and can be claimed on top of it.

Key facts:

- Both incentives can be combined
 - Battery must be 2–28 kWh usable capacity and on the CEC-approved battery list (for the NSW VPP incentive)
 - Property must have solar and be grid-connected
 - The NSW VPP payment is a one-off incentive for joining a VPP — the headline value is the gross amount; the net amount you receive may be lower after the provider's administration costs
 - The older NSW upfront battery hardware rebate (BESS1) has been replaced by the federal program
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Heat Pump Hot Water

Heading: Heat Pump Hot Water Rebates in NSW

Replacing an old electric hot water system with an energy-efficient heat pump can be heavily discounted through two stackable incentives: the NSW Energy Savings Scheme (ESS) and the federal STC scheme. The NSW ESS incentive for replacing an existing electric water heater with a heat pump is typically between \$405 and \$675, applied as an upfront discount on your quote. When combined with federal STCs, total savings generally range from \$1,400 to \$2,500 depending on your existing system, the new unit and your circumstances.

Key facts:

- Upfront discount, applied by an Accredited Certificate Provider (ACP) — not a cash-back
 - The heat pump must be on the Clean Energy Regulator's approved register
 - A minimum 5-year warranty against defects is required (for tanks 700L or less)
 - A nomination form must be signed before installation begins — discounts cannot be claimed for work already completed
 - Get multiple quotes, as each installer offers different pricing
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Air Conditioning (Reverse-Cycle)

Heading: Reverse-Cycle Air Conditioning Rebates in NSW

NSW households and small businesses can receive an upfront discount when installing or upgrading to a high-efficiency reverse-cycle air conditioner, through the NSW Energy Savings Scheme (ESS).

The discount is applied to your quote by an Accredited Certificate Provider (ACP), and the amount depends on the efficiency rating and capacity of the unit you choose — more efficient units generate a larger discount.

Key facts:

- Upfront discount via an ACP under the NSW ESS
- Available to both households and businesses
- The discount amount depends on the size and efficiency of the unit — there is no single fixed figure
- Unit must meet the scheme's efficiency eligibility requirements

NOTE TO DEV / OWNER (do not publish this line): Deliberately no fixed dollar figure here. NSW does NOT offer a "\$7,000 aircon rebate" — that claim seen on some competitor sites is inaccurate and a legal risk to repeat. The real ESS aircon incentive is a variable, model-dependent discount. If you want an exact figure for a specific unit, it can be generated from the "Safeguard certificate estimator" on energy.nsw.gov.au.

Commercial LED Lighting

Heading: Commercial LED Lighting Upgrades in NSW

Businesses in NSW can cut lighting energy costs by up to 80% by upgrading to LED through the NSW Energy Savings Scheme (ESS). Upgrades are delivered by Accredited Certificate Providers (ACPs), who create energy savings certificates and pass the value back as a discount, reducing the upfront cost of the project.

Important 2026 update: The simple Commercial Lighting Energy Savings Formula method closed on 31 March 2026. Commercial lighting upgrades now use the "Project Impact" method (PIAM&V), which involves more detailed energy measurement and documentation. For larger facilities the savings remain substantial, but projects now require a provider who specialises in this method.

Key facts:

- Delivered as a discount via an ACP under the NSW ESS
- Requires a minimum customer co-payment of at least \$5 (excl GST) per MWh of energy saved
- Upgrades must comply with lighting standards (AS/NZS 1680 and NCC Section F4.4)
- Old equipment must be recycled/disposed of by the provider
- Commercial upgrades now use the Project Impact (PIAM&V) method following the March 2026 change

NOTE TO DEV / OWNER (do not publish this line): The commercial LED deadline change is the detail most competitor sites currently get wrong. Keeping it accurate is a differentiator and protects you from misleading-conduct claims.

Bonus: NSW Home Energy Saver Program (finance, not a rebate)

Heading: NSW Home Energy Saver Program

To help with the upfront cost of these upgrades, the NSW Government offers the Home Energy Saver Program: an interest-free loan of up to \$15,000, repayable over up to 10 years, with no fees or interest. From later in 2026, cash discounts of up to \$4,000 will also be available for lower-income households. This is a loan, not a grant — but it can be used to cover the remaining cost of solar, batteries, heat pumps and other upgrades after other rebates have been applied.

Key facts:

- Zero-interest loan up to \$15,000, repayable over up to 10 years
- Loans available to households with combined taxable income up to \$210,000
- Discounts (up to \$4,000) targeted at households earning up to \$80,000, or concession card holders
- Federal/NSW rebates are applied first, then the loan covers what's left

Page Disclaimer (PUBLISH THIS)

Information on this page is general only and was last updated in June 2026. Rebate and incentive values are linked to certificate market prices and government scheme rules, which change over time. Eligibility is assessed by your installer's Accredited Certificate Provider. For the most current details, refer to the NSW Government (energy.nsw.gov.au), IPART, and the Clean Energy Regulator. We are not affiliated with these government bodies, and amounts shown are indicative, not guaranteed.